forum for India to engage with the Central Asian republics. Nonetheless, because of internal differences—particularly between India and China—these groupings have had only limited utility. The NDB and AIIB have not proved adequate replacements for the World Bank and other multilateral development banks. The BRICS and SCO have sometimes been useful talk shops on specific issues.

More recently, India has entered into a variety of mini-lateral groupings involving the United States. Chief among these is the Quad, along with Japan and Australia. These countries have similar outlooks to the Indo–Pacific and have established a range of working groups to deliver regional public goods, including on health, investment, green technologies, maritime domain awareness, training, telecommunications and infrastructure. Although the Quad is not yet a security grouping involving the defence ministries, the four countries do conduct regular naval exercises, and much of their agenda is on security-adjacent issues. In part, the grouping is attempting to address the demands and concerns of smaller Indo–Pacific countries without contributing to a regional arms race. Another emerging minilateral group involving India and the United States has been I2U2 with the UAE and Israel. This has focused on economic and technological issues, including food security, clean energy, space, and investment, with the expectation that such cooperation can facilitate closer strategic partnerships in the future.

Beyond these ‘mini-laterals’ (and regional groupings in which has assumed a leadership role such as BIMSTEC or IORA), India has recently experimented with creating a new category of India-led treaty-based international organizations. The first such effort involved the International Solar Alliance (ISA) headquartered in India. New Delhi has since tried to establish similar groupings such as the Centre for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI). These efforts involve drafting a treaty, opening it up for membership, ensuring ratification, establishing and staffing a secretariat, and thereafter working towards effective outcomes.

As new issues and actors start shaping the global governance agenda and legacy institutions wither or stagnate, the demands for India to establish,